

NARI SHAKTI ACT

to 850 would allow 283 women to enter Parliament— in absolute numbers, over 100 more than the 181 derived from the present strength of 543. And it can do so while still keeping a higher pool of unreserved seats for everyone.

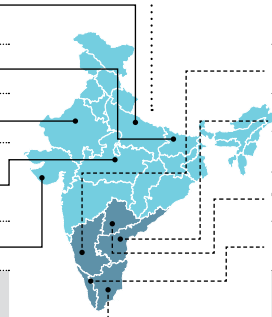
Q. WHAT IS THE BEST WAY TO CRACK THE DELIMITATION CONUNDRUM?

Delimitation is the process of redrawing the boundaries of parliamentary and assembly constituencies after every Census, so that representation remains fair as the population changes. Governed by Articles 81, 82 and 170 of the Constitution, it is meant to uphold a simple democratic principle: one person, one vote, one value. India has redrawn its constituencies four times—in 1952, 1963, 1973 and 2002. Each of the first three exercises enlarged the Lok Sabha: from 494 seats after the 1951 census to 522 after 1961, and 543 after 1971. Then came the freeze. Indira Gandhi's 42nd Amendment suspended further realloca-

THE NORTH VS SOUTH BATTLE

The five biggest north Indian states account for nearly 44% of the population, contribute over 29% to the GDP and have 200 seats

State	Share of India's population	Share of GDP	Lok Sabha seats
Uttar Pradesh	17.22%	8.77%	80
Bihar	9.10%	2.91%	40
Rajasthan	5.85%	5.05%	25
Madhya Pradesh	6.25%	4.49%	29
Gujarat	5.17%	8.05%	26
Total	43.59%	29.27%	200



The five south Indian states account for over 19% of the population, contribute nearly 31% to the national GDP and have 129 seats

State	Share of India's population	Share of GDP	Lok Sabha seats
Tamil Nadu	5.51%	8.93%	39
Karnataka	4.87%	8.49%	28
Andhra Pradesh	3.81%	4.72%	25
Telangana	2.73%	4.85%	17
Kerala	2.57%	3.77%	20
Total	19.49%	30.76%	129

Despite having less than half the population of northern states, southern states have a 24% share of LS seats while northern states have 36%

The southern states contribute 31 per cent to national GDP, compared with 29 per cent from the northern states

Barring Gujarat, all northern states have a fertility rate higher than 2, while all southern states have fertility rate less than 2, indicating that population divide is likely to grow